AI Layoffs vs. Hiring (2026) — Overview

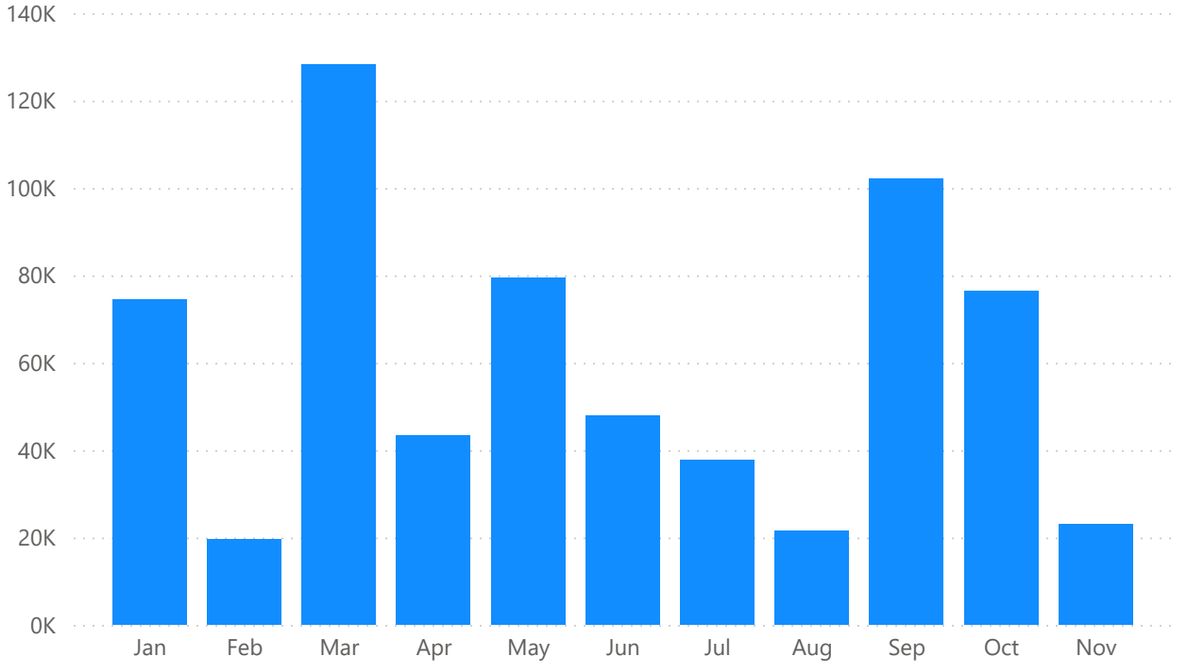
643
Announcements

653K
People Cut

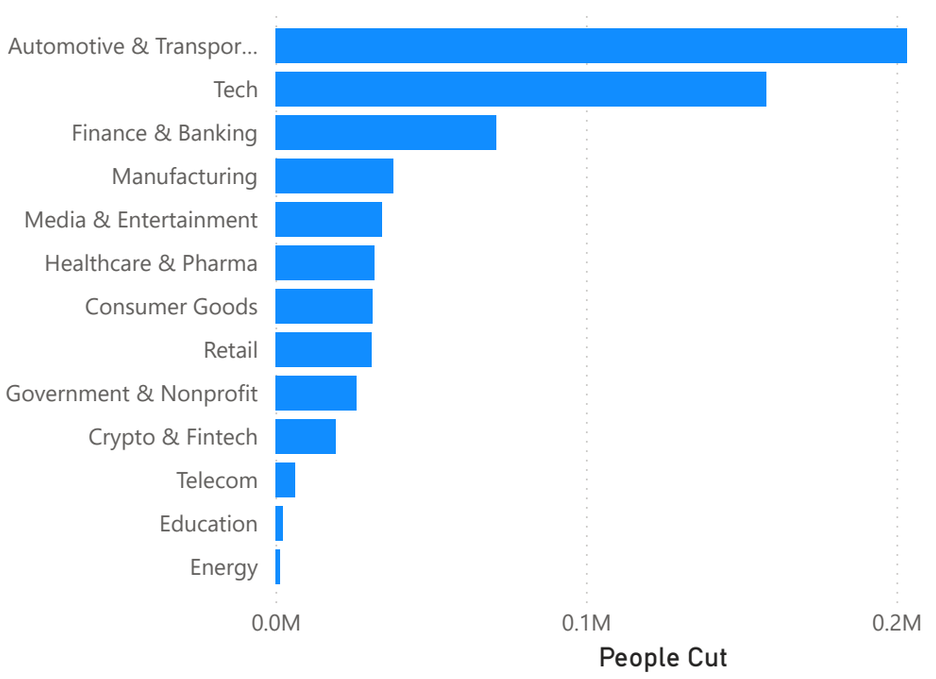
561
Companies

16.9%
AI People Share (Strict)

Announced job cuts per month (2026)



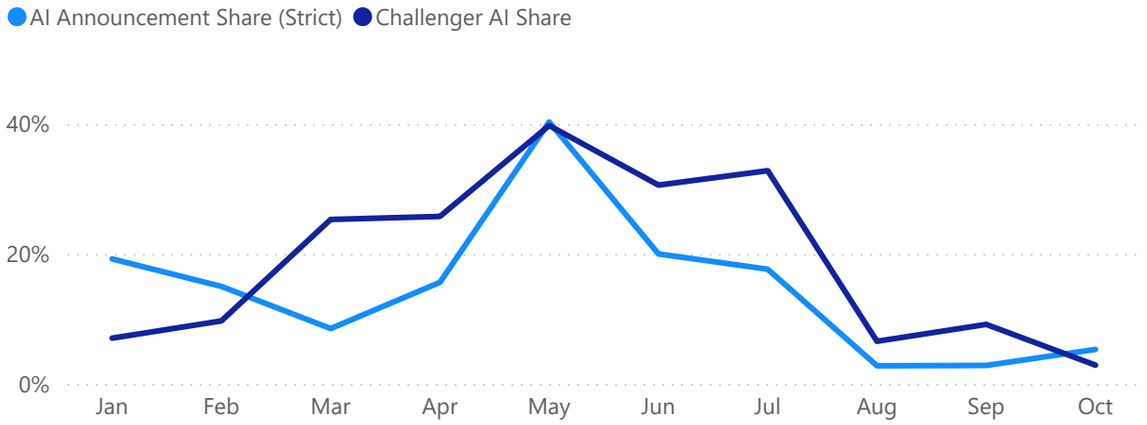
Announced job cuts by industry



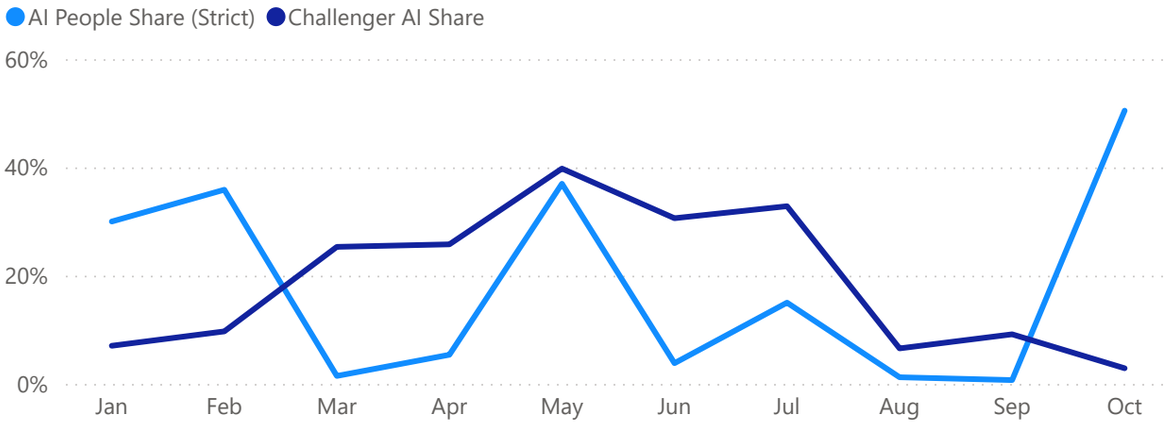
Source: layoffhedge.com (2026-11-08), validated against news sources. Main analysis: 643 announcements. "Announced job cuts", not jobs lost. November 2026 is a partial month (data until 6 Nov).

How often did companies cite AI? (strict definition)

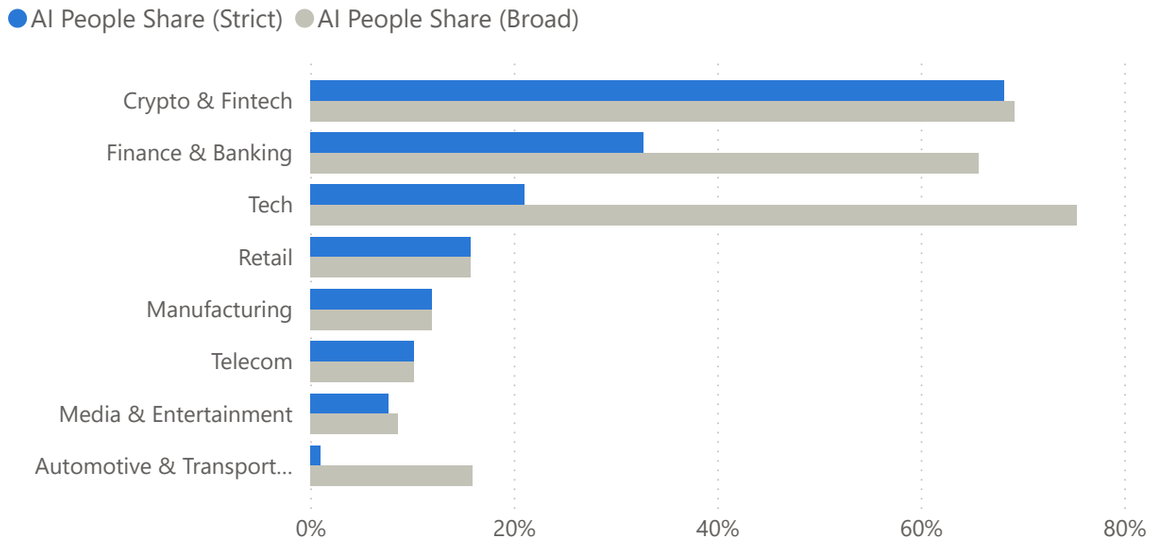
A. Share of announcements citing AI vs. Challenger (US)



B. Share of people in AI-attributed cuts vs. Challenger (US)



AI share by industry (10+ announcements) — strict vs. broad



Median people — AI announcements

295

Median AI (Strict)

Median people — other announcements

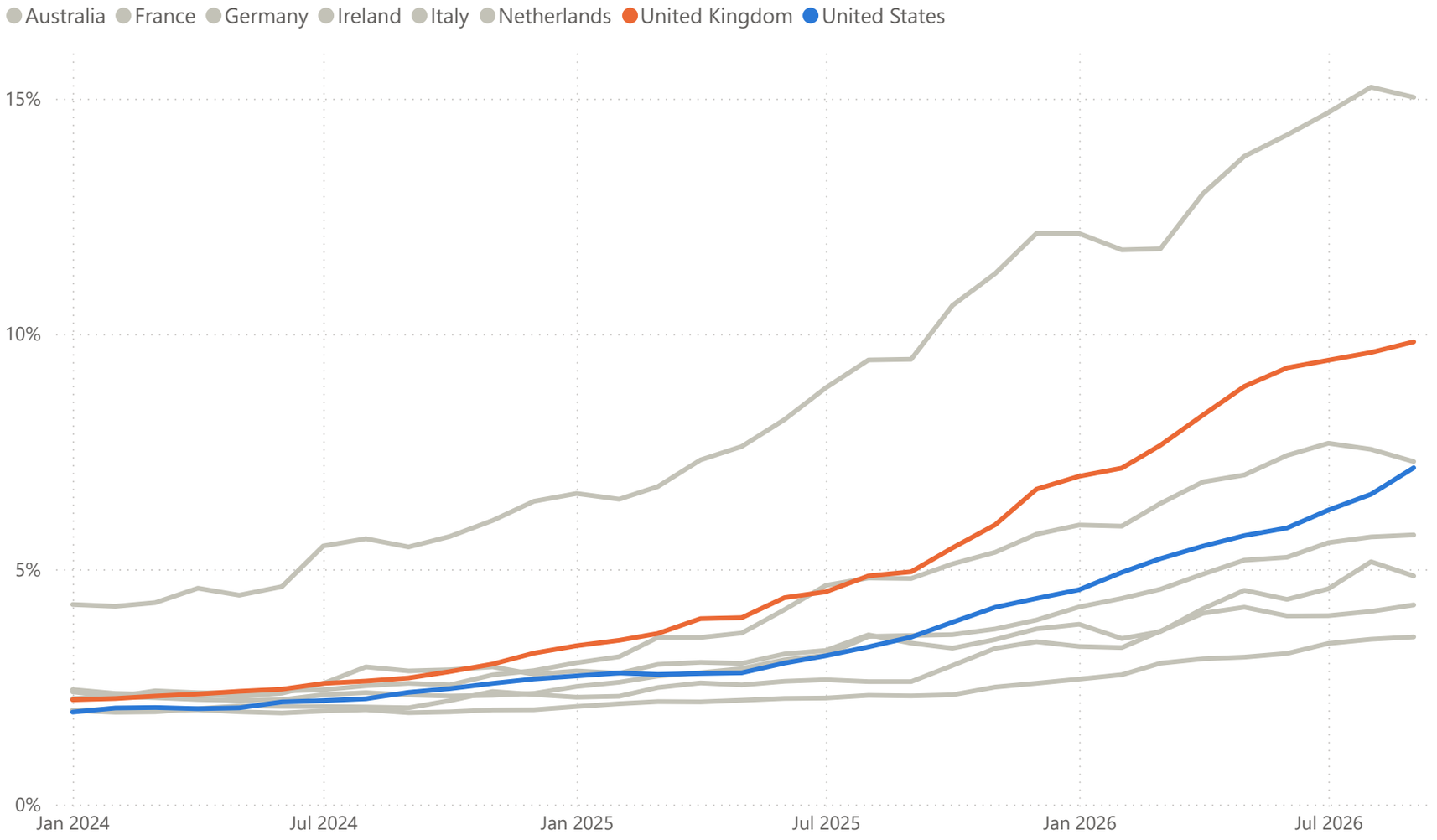
180

Median Non-AI

Strict = AI cited, label not questionable, number not "up to …". Chart A: announcements citing AI track Challenger (correlation 0.72). Chart B: one Dutch Government plan (25,000, outside the US) drives the October spike. Sources: layoffhedge.com; Challenger, Gray & Christmas.

Share of job postings mentioning AI (Indeed)

The share of job postings mentioning AI doubled in a year (US and UK highlighted)



US — Sep 2025

3.6%

Indeed AI Share

US — Sep 2026

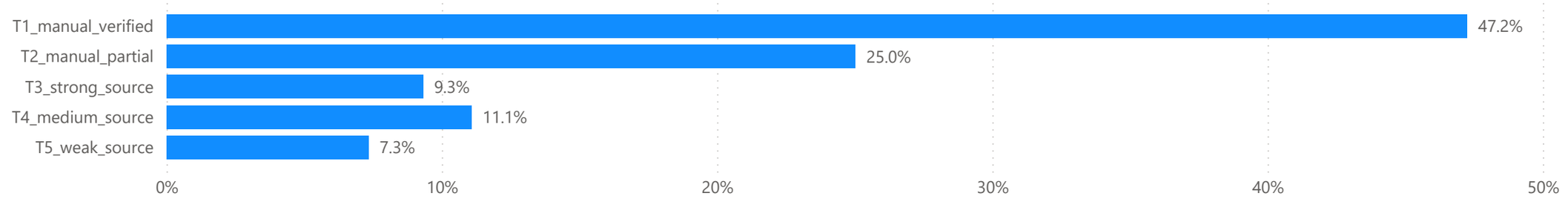
7.2%

Indeed AI Share

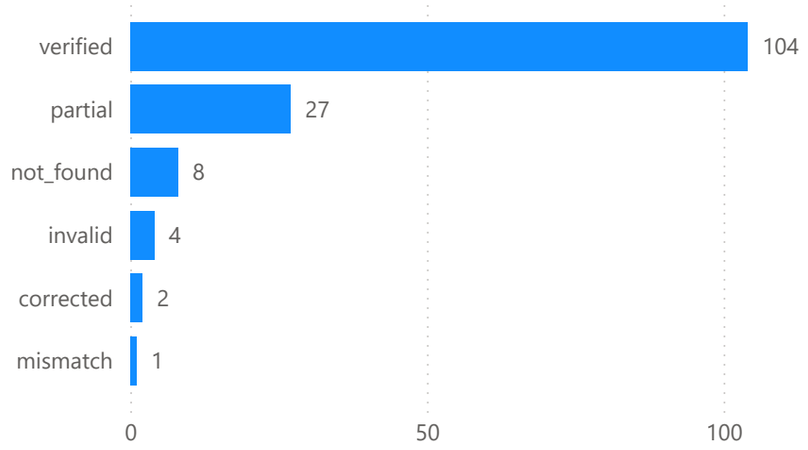
Indeed measures the share of job postings that mention AI — not demand for AI skills (postings of AI companies and "we use AI in hiring" disclosures count too). Canada excluded: an Ontario disclosure law inflated its series in 2026. Source: Indeed Hiring Lab AI Tracker (CC BY 4.0).

How reliable is the data? 146 rows were checked by hand against news sources

Share of people by reliability tier (T1 = verified by hand … T5 = weak source)



Results of manual verification (146 rows)



Checked by hand (T1–T2)

72.3%

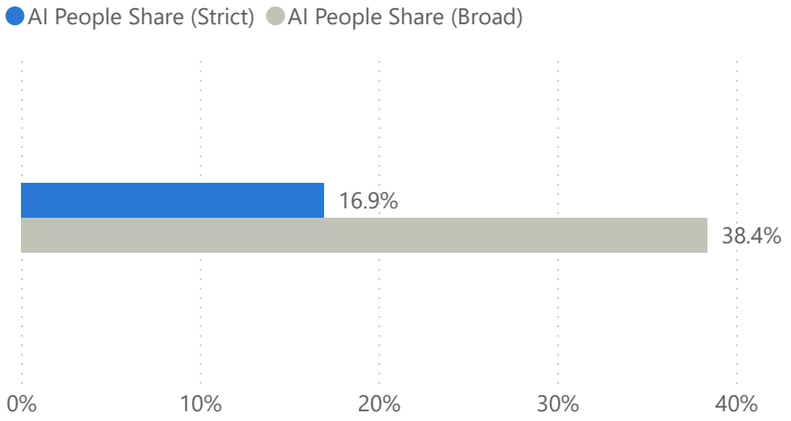
People Share of To…

Verified core (T1–T3)

81.6%

People Share of To…

AI share: headline (strict) 16.9% vs. upper bound (broad) 38.4%



How the data was validated

- Every large row (3,000+ people) and every AI-labelled row was compared with news sources, plus a random sample of small rows.
- Found and fixed: 4 announcements from earlier years (excluded) and 2 wrong numbers (corrected: Verizon 3,000 → 500, Commerzbank 6,900 → 3,000).
- No row was deleted — problems are flagged, so every number can be recomputed.
- The findings stay the same when only verified rows are used (robustness check).
- Python, SQL and Power BI give identical numbers.

Sources: layoffhedge.com; news articles per row (see verification_log.csv).